

Facebook for BB10 update

Facebook for BlackBerry 10 update brings design tweaks along with some of the new photo upload settings. Get it from: <http://dgit.in/ZHbf13>

**Creative Cloud Out**

After unveiling the successor to its Creative Suite last month, Adobe's Creative Cloud is now available for download

Facebook India's mobile-first strategy to capture next billion

We speak with Kevin D'Souza, Country Growth Manager, Facebook India, about the social networking giant's evident focus on making the service truly mobile, and connected

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With its many recent forays into the mobile space, starting with the Facebook for Every Phone app, and followed by Facebook Messenger, Facebook Home, HTC First, the numerous data access partnerships with various carriers, and the newest integration with the Asha OS, the social networking giant has been taking some major steps in provide its services across devices, regions and platforms, ensuring a large part of its massive userbase is connected on-the-go.

We decided to speak with Facebook about its plans in the mobile space.

What is the future of mobile social networking, and social networking overall, according to you?

With increasing mobile internet penetration, mobile social networking will be an integral part of society. At Facebook, we help people connect across platforms with features including chat, messaging, email, SMS and Groups. We want our users to have access to information and be able to reach anyone they want.

A report by Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI) and IMRB states that number of mobile internet users is expected to grow further to 130.6 million (by March 2014) and 164.8 million by March 2015 which itself explains the increasing database of people accessing internet through mobile devices.

We are also witnessing people signing up to Facebook accounts with their phone numbers and not really through email addresses, though we have both the options. These are people who probably don't even have an email address.



Kevin D'Souza, Country Growth Manager, Facebook India

Recently, we have realised that out of every 5 minutes, mobile users spend 1 minute on Facebook.

What opportunities does mobile create for Facebook?

The proliferation of mobile devices is expanding the market of people who can use Facebook and simultaneously driving deeper engagement with our product. Today over 751 million people use Facebook on a mobile device each month, and 70% of them return to Facebook every day compared to 40% of desktop users. To bring powerful social experiences to more people around the world, we're working across the entire mobile industry- with operators, hardware manufacturers, OS providers, and application developers. We're very excited about the opportunity to bring millions of additional people online via Facebook through these joint efforts.

Is having multiple apps for a single platform a strategy for Facebook (e.g., Facebook

Messenger and Facebook app in iOS both featuring the same functionality)? Will there ever be a single app for all functions?

We are a mobile-first company and innovate constantly to improve the mobile experience across all devices. The idea behind every offering whether it is 'Facebook for every phone app', Facebook Messenger or Facebook Home, is to connect people in a most convenient manner possible and create an ecosystem for users to provide an improved Facebook experience. Home is the first example of a new and different Facebook experience built leveraging the openness of Android platform. Similarly, "Facebook for Every Phone" app was built to deliver Smartphone-like Facebook experience on feature phones. In India, the app is available in Hindi and seven other local Indian languages.

Can mobile become a major revenue generator for Facebook?

Mobile is a major source of revenue. Last year, around this time, we had no revenue from mobile and at the end of 2012, 23% of Facebook's Q4 revenue was generated by mobile ads. Also, since launching mobile app install ads in October, they're already being used by 20% of the top 100 iOS apps to accelerate growth.

How do you see Facebook's mobile strategy evolving in the future?

Today we see ourselves as a true mobile company. Going forward, our mobile experiences will be the best way to use Facebook, we will help mobile developers grow their apps and make them social, and we will develop mobile ad products that allow marketers to reach our unique audience in compelling ways.

For the complete interview, visit <http://dgit.in/161VmmV>.